



Fan baiting: Interviewers often target angry CSK fans near Chepauk, pushing them to make extreme statements about the team's form. M. VEDHAN

A fitting mentor and a viral chase at Chepauk!

Our correspondents **capture the essence** of IPL cricket as it hurtles towards the business end — delivering thrilling action on the field and compelling stories off it.

On IPL match days, the outskirts of the Chepauk Stadium in Chennai resemble a hunting ground.

The prey? Unsuspecting cricket fans, mostly of the Chennai Super Kings variant.

The predators? Camera-wielding,

mic-holding interviewers — representing YouTube pages, TV channels and cricket websites — scouring for viral content.

These interviewers prowl Chepauk's approach roads before and after every game, scavenging on the ire of a frustrated CSK fanbase, provoking them into outrageous

comments — either in defence of their struggling team or lamenting its shortcomings.

The fans are baited by the interviewers with the prospect of a few seconds of fame, while also providing them with a window to vent their disappointments — an on-camera therapy session if you will.